

Apple had co-designed the interface, received the total responsibility of Thunderbolt. In its first two iterations, it used Mini DisplayPort connector and for Thunderbolt 3 it switched to using USB Type-C.

Thunderbolt from ground up was designed to be mother-of-all-interfaces, with abilities to stream media at extremely low latency, support PCI Express and even provide DC power. They really didn't want you to use any other interface. Because of its speed, it stands as an incredible option for streaming audio to your system and real-time effects processing. If your tastes have made you sensitive to even the minor latencies of older USB connectors, Thunderbolt will come to your rescue. It can even daisy-chain up to 6 devices and help reduce loss of time due to heavy transfers. The only catch - its price tag. With Firewire gone and older USBs being too weak to handle the modern demands, Thunderbolt seems to be moving towards the crown.



The lightning connector from Apple

With the iPhone 7, Apple officially dropped a bomb on its support for 3.5 mm phone connector. Lightning was introduced to completely replace it. Although a Chinese company, LeEco, was the first to ditch the 'headphone jack' for USB type-C.

The reason why Lightning connector is garnering more traction than the other companies' alternatives phone connectors

is that Lightning was already established for audio by Apple. In 2014 itself Apple released specifications for Lightning port to its Made-For-iPhone/iPad/iPod (MFi) program. Why would Apple exactly switch to total Lightning interface? Well other than the fact that Apple has plans for global domination, the phone connectors are too old. Even with their revisions, the hardware they're based on is outdated. Modern fidelity needs demand more power and Lightning is here to provide that. Unpowered audio systems are forced to use the amps built inside mobile devices because the phone connector is too weak to transfer the power needed. Now in a place where even the battery has a hard time stretching, expecting better amps is pointless. This is where Lightning will shine, as it can push much more power to the audio systems compared to the traditional phone connectors.